

CONFERENCE OF AFRICANS PORTS

THÈME :

**African Smart Port:
AI and Cybersecurity
Driving Performance**



**PORT DE CASABLANCA,
MAROC**



**15 – 17
SEPTEMBER 2026**

**ORGANISED
BY**



**UNDER THE AEGIS OF
THE SECRETARIAT**



**UNDER THE HIGH
PATRONAGE OF**



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01 – STAKES AND VISION

➤ 3 %

Global Trade Target

2030

Vision Horizon

54

African Mondial Nations

MARITIME CONTEXT

The African port sector is undergoing an unprecedented transformation, driven by the urgency of digital transition, decarbonization, and logistical resilience. It is within this dynamic that the **African Ports Conference** (COPAF 2026) is taking place, co-organized by the Research and Training Cabinet (CRF Perfection) and the **PMAWCA (AGPAOC)**. Focused on Artificial Intelligence, cybersecurity, and terminal digitalization, this edition aims to equip maritime decision-makers with the technological tools essential to propelling Africa to the center of global trade.

To host this strategic event, the Port of Casablanca was chosen—a true economic engine and pioneer of the "**Smart Port**" model in Africa, thanks to the success of its PortNet single window. This historic hub successfully demonstrates how innovation and intermodal connectivity can reinvent logistical performance. Bringing together **COPAF 2026** in Casablanca thus offers participants a living laboratory to adopt best practices in digital transition and strengthen South-South cooperation.

02 — CONFERENCE OBJECTIVES

Create a platform of excellence to enable African maritime decision-makers to adopt disruptive technologies (**AI, digitalization**) in order to accelerate the transition of ports toward a high-performing and secure "**Smart Port**" model.

SPECIFIC OBJECTIVES

- **Learn from the local model:** Analyze the successes of paperless processes and the single window system of the Port of Casablanca (PortNet).
- **Integrate AI:** Identify opportunities for applying AI to optimize terminal management and cargo processing.
- **Secure data:** Define collective cybersecurity strategies to protect critical port infrastructure.
- **Streamline the Hinterland:** Improve multimodal connectivity between ports and landlocked countries.
- **Strengthen Cooperation:** Facilitate strategic networking and South-South partnerships among African ports.
- **Learn through immersion:** Observe innovations in real-world conditions during field visits to the Port of Casablanca.

03 — THEMATIC PILLARS

Each day of the conference addresses a full theme, structured around 4 exchange formats: **Plenary Sessions, Organizational Learning Panels, Case Study Workshops, and Reflection Roundtables.**

PILLAR 1 — AI & STRATEGIC VISION

(Day 1— 15 September)

- Understand the technological landscape and identify opportunities.
 - AI at the heart of the Smart Port revolution
 - Automation of port operations through AI
 - Case studies: Successes and failures of AI projects in Africa and worldwide
 - Digital maturity assessment of port authorities



PILLAR 2 — OPERATIONAL EXCELLENCE & SECURITY

(Day 2 — 16 September)

- See how AI is transforming field operations: quays, terminals, and access points.
 - Arrival prediction (ETA) and smart berth management
 - Hinterland flow efficiency and urban congestion reduction
 - Automated anomaly detection (scanners, CCTV)
 - Port cybersecurity in the face of criminal threats



PILLAR 3 — DATA-DRIVEN GOVERNANCE & ROADMAP

(Day 3 — 17 September)

- Prepare for post-training implementation and optimize change management.
 - Economic model of AI and port ROI calculation
 - Data governance and Data-Driven culture
 - Real-time monitoring via predictive dashboards
 - Smart port KPIs for continental competitiveness



04 — ADDED VALUE OF THE PORT OF CASABLANCA



1. The Pioneer of Digitalization and Single Window Systems (PortNet)

For a conference focused on "Smart Ports" and AI, Casablanca is the perfect example. It is here that PortNet, the national single window for foreign trade, was deployed. The port serves as a model for integrating paperless supply chains, bringing concrete legitimacy to COPAF's workshops on digital transition.

3. A Model of Intermodal Connectivity

Casablanca is not limited to the sea. It is an interconnected hub (highways, ONCF rail networks, and direct proximity to Mohammed V Airport). This "hinterland" connectivity model is a crucial topic for all African port directors general seeking to relieve urban congestion.

2. The Trade Hub of West Africa

The Port of Casablanca has historically been the primary trading partner for ports in the sub-region (Senegal, Côte d'Ivoire, Benin, Togo). Hosting COPAF here strengthens the South-South cooperation framework advocated by PMAWCA and centralizes discussions where West African cargo flows actually intersect.

4. A Showcase for Modernizing Mature Infrastructure

Unlike ports built from scratch, Casablanca has successfully reinvented itself over the decades. Terminal management by operators such as Marsa Morocco or Somaport proves that a historic port can integrate cybersecurity, automation, and AI into existing structures—a daily challenge for most ports in West and Central Africa.

05 — TARGET AUDIENCE



Directors General / CEOs of Port Authorities: Strategic leadership



Directors of Strategy and Development: Planning & governance



Chief Information Officers (CIOs) / IT Directors: Digital transformation



Terminal and Operations Managers: Operational excellence



Harbor Master's Office: Maritime safety, security & regulation

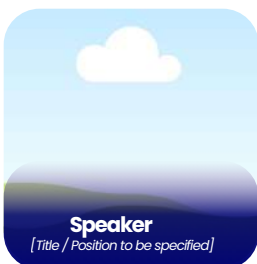


Innovation & Technology Managers: Smart Port deployment

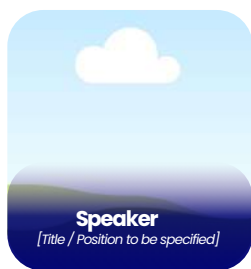
06 — OUR SPEAKERS



Director General of CRF Perfection, Dr. William ODAH has been supporting West African institutions and companies for many years in their strategic governance, training, and port development projects. He regularly works with public and private stakeholders in the maritime and logistics sector, with a focus on organizational structuring and capacity building. His expertise encompasses institutional change management, executive training, and strategic support for high-stakes port projects.



Marc Biegniébé is the Director General of ANAXAR, a road transport company operating along the corridors connecting the Port of Lomé to hinterland countries—Burkina Faso, Mali, and Niger. With over 10 years of experience in the port and cross-border supply chain, he works on corridor fluidity, customs clearance, and transport digitalization in West Africa.



Renato TCHOBO is Chief Digital & IT Officer at CRF Perfection, where he leads web development, digital strategy, and the digital transformation of institutional and event projects. As a freelance consultant in web development and community management, he designs and deploys end-to-end digital platforms—from inception to production—for organizations based in Cotonou and internationally. His expertise covers the structuring of complex digital projects, process automation, and strategic advisory for digital transformation.

Additional international experts will be announced soon
on copaf-ports.com

07 — LOGISTICS & PRACTICAL DETAILS

Venue:

Port of
Casablanca,
Morocco

Languages:

French & English
with pan-
African
simultaneous
interpretation

Educational Materials:

Pre-loaded tablet with
case studies,
roadmaps, and a
Smart Port bibliography

VIP Service:

Dedicated concierge
service: airport-hotel
transfers and
protocol
management

Deadline:

Registration deadline:
August 31, 2026

08 — REGISTRATION FEES

3 500 €
PER
PARTICIPANT



- Airport welcome and hotel check-in
- Airport-Hotel shuttle (round trip)
- 4 nights accommodation in a 4-star hotel
- Breakfast & lunch during the 3 days
- Access to conferences, workshops & networking
- Guided tour of the Port of Casablanca
- Pre-loaded tablet with case studies
- Certificate of participation

09 — SPONSORSHIP & PARTNERSHIP

PLATINUM

GOLD

SILVER

BRONZE

Official Strategic Partner

Exclusive branding, keynote speaker slot, premium networking, co-branded communications, and VIP hospitality.

Strategic Partner

Logo placement, digital exhibition booth, and engagement with the target audience.

REGISTRATION DETAILS

Participant Registration:

copaf-ports.com/

Sponsor & Strategic Partner:

copaf-ports.com/partenariats

Exhibitor Registration:

copaf-ports.com/exposition-digitale



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